
An MOU is a press release with two logos on it.

What allocators should check before believing a cross-border MOU means capital is coming.

A Korean pension fund signs an MOU with a Silicon Valley VC. Both sides act like capital moved.

It didn't. No subscription agreement, no capital call, no LPAC seat. Most die quietly within 18 months.

1

Deal sequencing

Who introduced whom, in what order. The government relationship almost always clears before the capital relationship can move.

2

Residency gates

Gulf sovereign vehicles and most Central Asian funds won't take a serious call without a local entity or resident partner. Rarely written down, always enforced.

3

Mandate language

Read what the MOU actually commits to. Co-investment rights, side letters, exclusivity. Most say almost nothing.

Korea signs more of these than any market I work in. Very few convert.

What do you look for in the first 90 days to tell a real deal from a press release?

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